

Handover & Version Control Protocol

How one inspection passes safely from office, to field, to technical, to sales, to admin

App v1.3 · Form 4.2 · Project 2.1 — Site Assessment Live app: <https://ds-js1.github.io/dryspace-inspect/>

What changed in v1.3. Photos now upload to SharePoint by themselves, so the old `media/` folder is gone and staff no longer upload photos through OneDrive. Everything for one inspection — the handover files and the photos — now sits in one folder. Sections 3, 7 and 8 changed most.

1. The problem this solves

An inspection is worked on by five people in sequence. The office starts it, the field team completes the assessment, technical writes the specification, sales prices it, admin issues it.

The app stores each inspection on the device it was entered on. Handover works by exporting a file and importing it elsewhere — which means the record can be copied, and two copies can drift apart.

The failure mode. Two people hold a file carrying the same inspection number, both edit it, and the version that reaches the client is missing whichever changes the other person made. Nobody notices until the client asks about something that was quoted from the wrong copy.

Until the record moves to a SharePoint List with a Power Apps front end, discipline has to do the work the software cannot yet do. This protocol is that discipline.

2. The one rule

One baton, never a copy. At any moment exactly one file is the live record, and it lives in SharePoint. The copy on your device is a working scratch pad.

In practice: if you are about to email an inspection file to a colleague, stop. Put it in the folder and send them the link.

3. SharePoint folder structure

One folder per inspection, in the **Site Inspections** site. The app creates it on the first upload and names it from the record, so it sorts and searches predictably:

```
Site Inspections ■ Shared Documents/
  INS-2026-0142 - Smith - 12 Marine Parade, Kirra/
    current/ ← exactly one draft file, ever. The live record.
    archive/ ← the frozen file from each completed handover
    photos/  ← uploaded by the app itself
```

Each subfolder does one job, and the discipline collapses if they are merged:

- `current/` — one file and one file only. Two files here means something has gone wrong and must be resolved before anyone edits anything (see §8).

- `archive/` — the frozen snapshot at each handover. This is your rollback. Never delete from it.

- `photos/` — full-quality originals. **The app puts these here.** Nobody uploads photos by hand any more.

Why its own site. Inspection media sits in Site Inspections rather than under the client folder, because client folders hold quotes and pricing. Uploading there would require giving every field inspector access to all of it.

File naming

The app names exported files for you. Do not rename them.

```
DS_Draft_INS-2026-0142_Smith_S02-FIELD_2026-08-15T1430_JS.json
■■ number ■■■ ■who■ ■ stage ■ ■■■■ when ■■■■ ■ by
```

Photos are named the same way, adding which part of the form they came from:

```
INS-2026-0142_Smith_2026-08-15_s4-wall-moisture-signs_001.jpg
```

So a file that has been downloaded or emailed still says whose job it is, without anyone having to look the number up.

You can tell at a glance which file is current, who exported it, and from which stage — without opening anything.

4. The handover ritual

Four steps, in this order, every time. **The order matters** — the last step is what actually stops forks.

Changed in v1.4. Steps 3 and 4 used to be done by hand, and on a phone they could not be done at all — the share sheet offered WhatsApp and Mail and no way to reach SharePoint. The app now does both itself. What follows is the ritual as it now stands; the manual version is kept below it, because it is still what you do when you have no signal.

1. **Set your stage and name.** At the top of the inspection, choose the Current stage and type your name. This is what stamps the filename and the audit trail.
2. ****Tap *Hand over through SharePoint**** at the foot of the form. The app uploads the record to this inspection's `current/` folder and moves the previous file into `archive/` — old steps 3 and 4, in that order, without you.
3. **Tell the next person**, with a link to the folder — not the file.
4. **Delete your device copy**, once they confirm they have it.

The app will stop you rather than guess, in two cases:

- `current/` **already holds two files.** It refuses and sends you to §8. Which of the two is the baton is not something software should decide.
- **Somebody else has handed over since you picked this up.** It says who and when, and asks. Continuing archives their file rather than deleting it, so their work is still recoverable — but it stops being the live record.

Do not skip the last step. Leaving your copy on the device is how the same inspection ends up being edited in two places. The app does not delete it for you: deleting somebody's only copy of a day's work on their behalf is not a thing it should do. If you are worried about losing work, that is what `archive/` is for.

Picking the baton up

****Tap *Take over an inspection from SharePoint**** on the home screen. It lists every inspection with a file waiting in `current/` and brings the one you choose onto your device. Nobody has to send you anything.

Photos already uploaded stay in SharePoint. They are not copied down, because they are already beside the record in `photos/`.

When you have no signal

Both paths still exist and are labelled *offline fallback*:

- *Share draft (offline fallback)* exports the file to the share sheet, photos embedded, exactly as before.
- *Import from a file (offline fallback)* takes one back in.

If you use these, **old steps 3 and 4 are yours again** — put the file in `current/` and move the previous one to `archive/` as soon as you have signal.

Before you hand over, check the photos have uploaded. The home screen says either how many files are waiting or *"All photos uploaded"*. Handing on a record whose photos are still sitting on your device passes on an incomplete job.

5. Stages and who holds the baton

The stage selector records who currently owns the record. Changing it is logged to the audit trail with your name and the time.

Stage	Who holds it	What they complete
S01 - OFFICE	Office / admin	Section 01 — client and property details, documents, listing URL
S02 - FIELD	Field inspector	Sections 02–06 and 03A — assessment, photos, hazards, access, discharge point
S03 - TECH	Technical team	Sections 07–09 — repair approach, measurement schedule, drainage design
S04 - SALES	Sales	Section 10 — pricing, timeline, exclusions, provisional sums
S05 - ADMIN	Admin	Contract details, QBCC, final checks before the quote is issued
S06 - CLOSED	Nobody — read only	Issued to the client. Reopen only by agreement.

Why 03A is lettered. The Safety, Access & Discharge section was numbered 03A rather than 04 so every existing section kept its number, and no existing SOP or downstream reference had to be renumbered.

6. Signing in — new in v1.3

Photos upload under the identity of whoever is signed in, so uploads are attributed to a real person rather than to "the app".

- Sign in once per device, from the home screen, with your ****Dryspace Microsoft account****. It is remembered.
- **Losing signal does not sign you out.** If you are ever asked to sign in again in the field, it is because the sign-in genuinely expired — nothing is lost, and the photos are still on the device.

- Access to the Site Inspections site is granted by permission group. Anyone who needs it and does not have it should ask the office rather than working around it.

7. Photos and video

Photos — the app handles these

Take photos in the **Camera app**, then attach them to the right field in the form. Not through the form's own camera: the camera roll keeps an independent second copy, and the location detail survives.

When you are back in signal, tap **Upload now**. The app:

- keeps a full-quality original for evidence and a smaller copy so reports stay emailable;
- names every file by job, date and which part of the form it came from;
- files them into that inspection's `photos/` folder;
- **reads every file back out of SharePoint and checks it arrived complete** before counting it as done.

Nothing is removed from your device on the strength of an upload that has not been confirmed.

Video — still manual

Video does not travel inside drafts or reports, and does not upload through the app. It is too large.

Set this on every field device before it goes out:

- Settings → Camera → Record Video → **1080p HD at 30 fps**
- Settings → Camera → Formats → **High Efficiency**

Roughly 60 MB per minute instead of around 400 MB, with no loss of useful detail at review size — a six-fold reduction for nothing.

Record with the Camera app, then upload to the inspection's folder using the OneDrive app, which uploads in the background and can be left running.

This replaces the WhatsApp habit. WhatsApp was used because it compresses and transfers in one step. This does the same thing without putting client property footage through a consumer messaging service.

8. SharePoint settings to turn on

One-time library settings on the **Site Inspections** site. These are what give you rollback and protection against deletion. Set them before rollout, not after.

1. **Versioning.** Library settings → Versioning settings → create major versions, **keep 100**. Every overwrite becomes a restorable version. *(Done 15 Aug 2026.)*
2. **Recycle bin.** 93 days — the Microsoft default, and not adjustable. Deletions are recoverable within that window. *(Confirmed 15 Aug 2026.)*
3. **Restrict delete.** A custom permission level named **Contribute - No Delete**, assigned to field and technical staff. They can upload and edit but cannot delete. *(Created and assigned to Julie and Mike, 15 Aug 2026.)*
4. **Documents in the left navigation.** So the library is one click from the site home rather than buried. *(Done 15 Aug 2026.)*

5. **Add shortcut to OneDrive.** So the folders are reachable from the OneDrive app on the iPad — still needed for video.

6. **Add the index columns.** Library settings → Create column. Add these six as **Single line of text**, and name them **exactly as written, with no spaces**:

Column	Holds
InspectionNo	INS-2026-0142
Client	Smith
Address	12 Marine Parade, Kirra
Stage	S02-FIELD
InspectionDate	2026-08-15
LastEditor	Jamie Stone

The app fills these in as it creates each inspection folder, so the folder list becomes a searchable index of every job — no separate register to keep, and nothing that can fall out of step with the folders themselves.

> **Spaces matter.** A column named "Inspection No" gets the internal name > `Inspection_x0020_No`, which will not match and the write is rejected. Create > them without spaces.

(Created 15 Aug 2026 and added to the default All Documents view.)

If the columns are missing the app carries on and simply does not fill them in — an upload is never refused because the index could not be written.

Verify the permission level with a real person, not on paper. Ask someone on *Contribute - No Delete* to upload a file and then try to delete it. A permission level that looks right in settings and does not bite in practice is worse than none, because it is trusted.

Together these answer the concern about someone accidentally or intentionally deleting inspection records: versioning restores overwrites, the recycle bin catches deletions, and the permission level prevents most of them happening.

9. If something has already gone wrong

Two files in `current/` Do not open either and start editing. Compare the timestamps and initials in the filenames, agree with the two people involved which is current, move the other to `archive/`, and note what happened.

The app warns you are about to overwrite newer work Importing an inspection that already exists shows both timestamps, both stages and both editors, and warns you when the copy on your device is the newer one. Read it rather than tapping through.

You are offered "keep both" This creates a fork — two records carrying the same inspection number. Only do it if you have been asked to.

A photo will not upload Tap *Try again*. If it keeps failing, tell the office **before deleting anything**. A failed upload leaves the original untouched on the device, so nothing is lost while it is being sorted out.

Something was deleted Site recycle bin first (93 days), then the `archive/` folder, then the weekly data backup from the app home screen. In that order.

10. Where this is heading

This protocol is an interim measure and it is honest about that. It is discipline standing in for software.

The agreed destination is a SharePoint List with one item per inspection and a Power Apps front end. At that point the record stops being a file and the baton rule stops being needed.

The field structure locked in v1.2, and the media structure locked in v1.3, are the specification for that build — so nothing done now is wasted.

When to make the move. The trigger is headcount and volume, not time. While it is a handful of people and a manageable number of live inspections, this protocol is cheaper than the migration.